

Data Limitations

One limitation of this dataset is that GradCafe depends on users choosing to submit their own information. Because of that, the entries may not reflect the full group of graduate school applicants. Some people may be more likely to post after receiving an acceptance or rejection, while others may never post at all. There are also missing GPA and GRE values in some entries. Since the information is entered by users, mistakes or inconsistent ways of reporting schools, programs, and scores are also possible.

Because of these issues, I would be careful about applying my results to graduate admissions as a whole. For example, 40.40% of the Fall 2026 entries in my database are acceptances. This tells me what is in my GradCafe dataset, but it does not mean that the overall graduate school acceptance rate is 40.40%. I also noticed some unusual GRE values in the data, which could affect the averages. The analysis is still useful for seeing patterns in the collected entries, but the results should be understood as patterns in this dataset rather than exact statistics for all applicants.